

Gambling in Greece — Market Analysis

Terminology

Term	Greek	Definition
TGR / Turnover	Κύκλος Εργασιών	Total amount staked by players. Every bet placed counts, regardless of outcome. This is the gross flow of money through the market — not revenue.
GGR	Ακαθάριστα Έσοδα / Μικτά Κέρδη	Gross Gaming Revenue. TGR minus player winnings. This is what operators actually keep, and what the state taxes. Equivalent to "revenue" in other industries.
OPAP	ΟΠΑΠ Α.Ε.	The dominant land-based operator — runs sports betting (PAME STOIXHMA), numbers games (KINO, LOTTO, TZOKER), and VLTs through ~4,000 retail shops.
VLT	Παιχνιομηχανήματα VLT	Video Lottery Terminals. Electronic slot-like machines in OPAP shops. Introduced late 2017, grew rapidly.
Online	Διαδίκτυο	Internet gambling — sports betting, casino games, poker — licensed and operated digitally. Includes OPAP's online arm and third-party operators.
Casinos	Καζίνα	Land-based casinos. Greece has ~9 licensed casinos (Parnitha, Thessaloniki, Loutraki, Rhodes, etc.).
State Lotteries	Ελληνικά / Κρατικά Λαχεία	Scratch cards (SKRATCH) and draw lotteries (Λαϊκό, Εθνικό, Πρωτοχρονιάτικο).
ODIE	ΟΔΙΕ / Ιπποδρομίες Α.Ε.	Horse racing betting. Operated by OPAP's subsidiary from 2015; suspended Jan 2024.

_marimo_row_id	year	category	metric	value_eur_millions	notes	
0	0	2012	OPAP	Turnover	3775.25	Land-based only; source: 2013 annual report table
1	1	2012	OPAP	GGR	1235.08	Land-based only; source: 2013 annual report table
2	2	2012	Casinos	Turnover	1890.16	source: 2013 annual report table
3	3	2012	Casinos	GGR	330.17	source: 2013 annual report table
4	4	2012	State_Lotteries	Turnover	263.88	source: 2013 annual report table
...	...	...	...	...	...	...
151	151	2024	ODIE	GGR	6.80	Horse racing; Ιπποδρομίες Α.Ε. suspended opera...
152	152	2024	Online	Turnover	NaN	2024 report only provides GGR data
153	153	2024	Online	GGR	1066.66	source: 2024 report summary table
154	154	2024	Total	Turnover	NaN	2024 report only provides GGR data
155	155	2024	Total	GGR	2878.85	source: 2024 report summary table

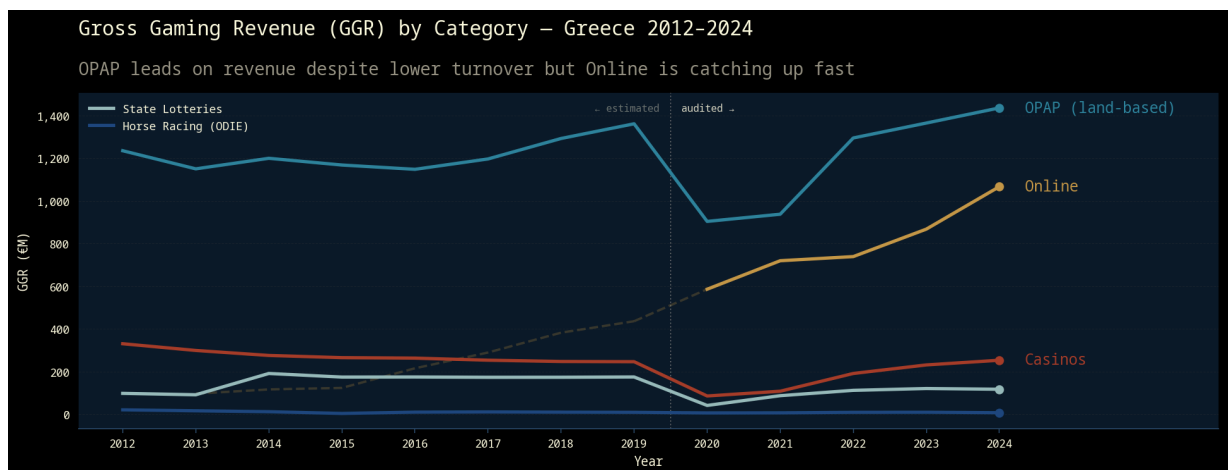
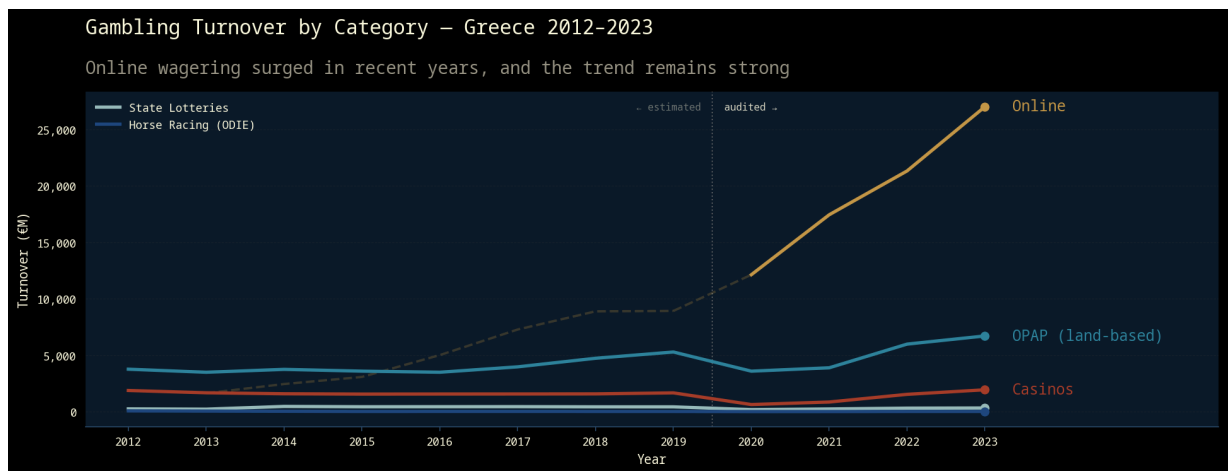
156 rows × 6 columns

Turnover by Gambling Category

Each line shows the total amount wagered (TGR — *Κύκλος Εργασιών*) per year, broken down by category.

The **Online** line is shown faded and dashed before 2020. During 2012–2019, online gambling operated under a transitional licensing regime (Art. 50, Law 4002/2011) in which operators self-declared revenues to the tax authority without formal auditing by the regulator (ΕΕΕΠ). Figures for this period are derived or estimated from report text and growth rates — not sourced from audited tables. From 2020 onward, all figures come from fully audited regulatory data. All other categories (OPAP land-based, Casinos, State Lotteries, Horse Racing) were formally reported throughout.

TGR data is not available for 2024 — the 2024 report switched to GGR-only reporting.



Hold Percentage

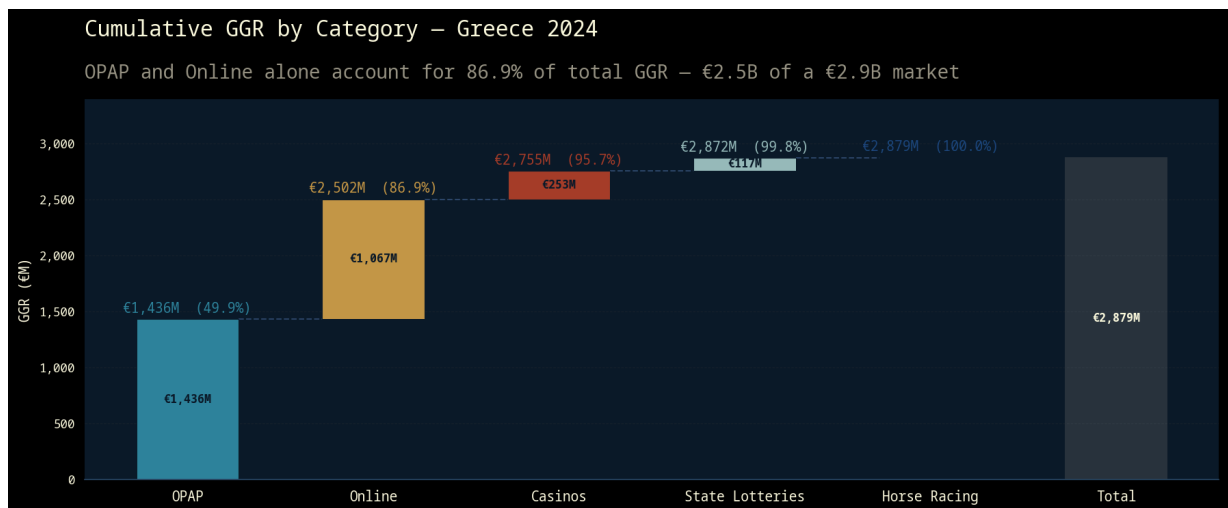
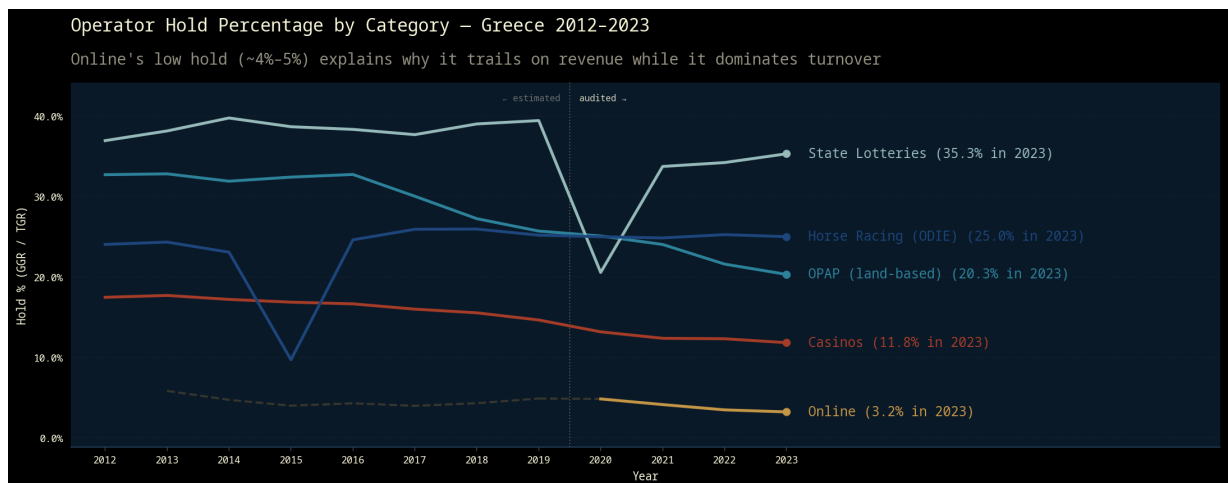
$$\text{Hold \%} = \text{GGR} \div \text{TGR} \times 100$$

This is the standard industry metric for how much of every euro wagered the operator retains as revenue. Its complement is the **Return to Player (RTP)** rate — what players get back on average. A hold of 5% means players receive €0.95 back for every €1 staked.

Hold % is structurally very different across gambling types:

- **Lotteries** are high-hold by design — a large share funds the state prize pool and government revenue
- **Casinos** sit in the middle — table games and slots have fixed mathematical edges
- **OPAP** blends sports betting margins with numbers games (KINO, LOTTO)
- **Online** is low-hold because digital operators compete on RTP to attract players

Only years where both TGR and GGR are available are shown (2024 is excluded — the 2024 report dropped TGR figures). The Online line is faded before 2020 for the same data-quality reason as above.



Summary

- The Greek gambling market has undergone a major transformation over the past decade, with online gambling growing from a negligible share to dominating turnover by 2023.
- OPAP remains the largest single operator by revenue, but online operators are rapidly closing the gap due to their dominant share of turnover, even with lower hold percentages.
- In 2024, OPAP and Online combined account for €2.5B of GGR, representing 86.9% of the total €2.9B market revenue.